

Chapter 178 Part 2: Extra Story 1-2

Back then, Liang Shi had thought Rainbow had lost the joys of childhood, but unexpectedly, her own daughter—even when someone wanted to play with her, she wouldn't play.

Occasionally when Liang Shi watched science fiction movies, she would watch along too.

If it were Mumu, she couldn't watch them at all and would only fuss about wanting to watch the story of two little red pandas.

Yes, the cartoons had already changed from the little rabbits that Ling Dang and the others used to watch to little red pandas.

Liang Shi bought them lots of fairy tale books. Chaochao wasn't interested at all, and Mumu wasn't interested either because there were too many words—she wanted to look at ones with pictures.

Liang Shi was even so worried about this that she couldn't sleep for several nights, and went to see Dr. Gu for psychological counseling.

Dr. Gu said this was a normal phenomenon and only indicated that Chaochao had a higher IQ.

So they could only let nature take its course.

With the two children making a ruckus at home, time flew by quickly.

It wasn't until they sent the two of them to kindergarten that Liang Shi began to focus on preparing to film.

She had previously been in two TV dramas with pretty good reputations—one was "Afterglow" in collaboration with Zhao Ying, and the other was "Sharp Edge," Gu Yixue's first time filming a TV drama, with the script co-written by Gu Yixue and Gu Xingyue.

There was also a movie called "Journey of the Heart" that was considered a minor hit, which had even been nominated for Best Actress. Unfortunately, due to the fierce competition that year, she regrettably didn't win.

But it was still considered recognition from the industry.

"Sharp Edge" had been a double success in both reputation and ratings at the time, even sparking a domestic suspense craze.

For an entire year, all major platforms were promoting suspense dramas. Gu Xingyue's "Blade" also triggered another wave in domestic suspense novels, and she became a highly sought-after suspense writer for a time.

Unfortunately, "Blade" touched on deeper social issues, making it difficult to pass censorship review,¹ so it was never filmed.

"Sharp Edge" was also nominated for Best Actress at the country's highest television awards. Liang Shi won the TV Queen title² with her superb acting skills. Afterward, she continued to film some dramas and movies one after another, but none were lead roles.

They were all supporting roles that felt pretty good, and she even won a Best Supporting Actress award.

However, these were all television awards.

Liang Shi had filmed fewer works in the past two years, but she had been continuously filming and continuously releasing them, never completely disappearing from the public eye.

She had also left behind quite a few memorable supporting characters.

Even so, what was more recognized domestically was still the film market.

The first project Liang Shi filmed after her return was a movie, in collaboration with Yang Shuyan, called "You in My Memory," which told the story of Alzheimer's disease.

The process of landing this role was also very difficult.

Because this role had a large time span, going from age 20 to 70, with elderly makeup accounting for half of the time.

Originally, the director didn't want to use this kind of new generation actor, but when casting was open to the entire society, the other roles were quickly decided—only the female lead role couldn't be settled.

Liang Shi had her eye on this script and also wanted to challenge herself again, so on the day of the audition, she went wearing elderly makeup.

In order to better portray the demeanor of elderly people and the daily life of those with Alzheimer's disease, Liang Shi spent an entire month—after dropping Chaochao and Mumu off at kindergarten—staying at a nursing home, specifically spending time with an elderly person who had Alzheimer's disease.

On the first day she went, Liang Shi and she chatted happily, introducing themselves.

On the second day she went, the elderly woman wouldn't remember Liang Shi.

Or sometimes she would remember on the second day, then forget after several days.

When her relatives came to visit her, they were always forgotten too, yet she would remember things from a very long time ago.

She would become forgetful, become melancholic, forgetting her growth in the process of growing old.

So when auditioning for the elderly scenes, Liang Shi moved the director.

In the end, the director chose her.

Yang Shuyan played a single mother in the movie.

If they had to rank billing, Yang Shuyan was first, because the story revolved around Yang Shuyan's character, but it would intersperse flashbacks, making it also a story about the inheritance of familial love.

The film happened to need a child actor.

Liang Shi had never thought of using her own daughter. The director's side had also selected a rather talented child actor, but two days after filming began, when it was time to film the child actor's scenes, the child actor who had been temporarily arranged couldn't come because she had fallen at school, hit her head on the steps, and gotten three stitches.

That day, Liang Shi and Yang Shuyan had evening scenes, so Xu Qingzhu brought the two little ones to visit the set.

The mischievous and active Mumu took advantage of Xu Qingzhu's inattention and ran around the set as if having the time of her life, and was spotted by the director.

The director held onto her and excitedly shouted on set: "Whose child is this?"

Liang Shi, who was rehearsing with Yang Shuyan, glanced over and was terrified, thinking Mumu had caused some trouble. She immediately ran over to grab her, "What happened?"

Mumu stared with her big eyes: "Mama!"

And so, through Mumu's self-recommendation, Liang Shi played her... grandmother.

For quite a long time afterward, Mumu would call out regardless of time or place: "Grandma~"

Liang Shi: "....."

The most ridiculous thing was one weekend after filming wrapped, when she and Xu Qingzhu took the two kids to eat at KFC. Liang Shi took Mumu to the counter to order, and Mumu really wanted to drink iced Coke, but because she had just had an upset stomach yesterday, Liang Shi refused to buy it for her no matter what. After getting their food, she walked toward their table.

Mumu stood there pouting, looking at her back with an aggrieved expression.

Liang Shi hardened her heart and ignored her anger, not even turning back to look, afraid she would go soft.

And so, in full view of everyone, in a KFC that was almost completely full, Shen Xuan stood in the middle of the restaurant and loudly shouted: "Grandma!"

Liang Shi: "?"

In that instant, Liang Shi felt everyone's eyes on her.

That day, Liang Shi was wearing a sky-blue fitted T-shirt, high-waisted jeans, with straightened hair, and had even dyed it a bit blue for an upcoming variety show—a blue-black color—and was wearing silver earrings.

Although she was wearing a mask, anyone could see she looked like she was just in her early twenties.

But Shen Xuan, as if afraid people didn't know, trotted a few steps over to tug at Liang Shi's hem, acting cute with an aggrieved expression: "Grandma~ just buy it for me!"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi looked toward Xu Qingzhu, only to see Xu Qingzhu immediately lower her head, pretending to drink her Coke.

But in that moment, Liang Shi saw it.

Xu Qingzhu was secretly laughing!

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1. In China, all media content must pass government censorship review (过审, guò shěn) before being published or broadcast. Content touching on sensitive social or political issues often faces difficulty getting approved. ↩
 2. "视后" (shì hòu) literally means "TV Queen" and refers to winning the Best Actress award at major television award ceremonies. It's the television equivalent of winning Best Actress at film awards. ↩